

ABSTRACT

This study examines college students' preferences between e-books and printed books in academic contexts, highlighting how digital technology has transformed reading and learning practices. The purpose was to explore students' reading habits, the reasons behind their format preferences, and the challenges associated with both formats to better understand their impact on academic study. A mixed-method approach was adopted, combining surveys for quantitative data and interviews for qualitative insights. A structured questionnaire using Google Forms was distributed to 44 college students, supported by direct observations in libraries and study areas. Non-probability sampling techniques such as convenience, purposive, quota, and snowball sampling were applied. Data were analyzed with Excel to identify key patterns and trends in preferences. The results show that most students read daily or several times a week, spending from less than one hour to more than three hours weekly on both printed books and e-books. E-books were chosen more often for their accessibility, portability, quick search features, and cost-effectiveness, while printed books were valued for their familiarity, reading comfort, and ability to promote concentration. However, challenges were noted: e-books often caused eye strain and distractions, while printed books were criticized for being heavier and more expensive. When asked to rely on only one format, the majority of students preferred e-books, reflecting a gradual shift toward digital learning. Many also predicted that e-books will eventually replace printed books but suggested maintaining a balanced collection in college libraries to meet diverse learning needs. In conclusion, e-books are emerging as the dominant choice, though printed books remain essential for focused study, making a hybrid approach the most effective solution.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Sr No.	Particulars	Page No.
1.	Abstract	
2.	Table of Contents	
3.	List of Figures	
4.	Chapter 1:Introduction	
5.	Chapter 2:Literature Review	
6.	Chapter 3:Methodology	
7.	Chapter 4:Field Work Description,Observation and Analysis	
8.	Chapter 5:Conclusion and Recommendations	
9.	References	
10.	Appendices	

List of Figures



✦ Students engaged in digital forms during research.



✦ Students actively filling out digital survey questionnaire completion.



✦ Group of students providing feedback through digital forms.



✦ Students making every tap count for research.



✦ Study time meets survey time—clicked and done!

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

In today's world, technology has touched almost every part of our lives, including the way we read and learn. For college students, books are more than just sources of information—they are daily companions in study and personal growth. With the rise of e-books, students now have the choice between the traditional feel of printed books and the digital convenience of carrying an entire library on a single device. This shift has sparked an interesting question: do students still prefer the comfort of a printed book, or do they find more value in the flexibility of an e-book?

Printed books often bring a sense of familiarity—turning pages by hand, scribbling notes in the margins, and avoiding the strain of a backlit screen. Many students feel these aspects help them focus better and connect more deeply with the material.

On the other hand, e-books appeal to a digital generation by offering features like quick search tools, instant downloads, portability, and often lower costs, making them especially practical for busy student life. These differences highlight not just a matter of convenience, but also how students experience learning itself.

By exploring student preferences between e-books and printed books, this survey aims to capture real experiences, habits, and challenges that students face in their academic journey. The goal is to better understand how reading choices affect not only study practices but also overall learning satisfaction. This perspective does not simply compare two formats; it looks at how today's students interact with knowledge in ways that are shaped by both tradition and technology.

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

1. Since 2025:

- [A COMPARATIVE STUDY OF E-BOOKS AND PRINTED BOOKS ON ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE: PERCEPTION FROM THE UNIVERSITY STUDENTS](#)

N SAIJU, N TAMANG, P TAMANG, P BASTOLA... - INTERNATIONAL ..., 2025 - elibrary.ru

2. Since 2021:

- [Teaching Materials of Local Wisdom-Based E-Book in Digital Learning: A Systematic Literature Review](#)

UA Ulum, [A Muhyidin](#)... - ... , Sosial, dan Agama, 2025 - ejournal.insuriponorogo.ac.id

- [The textbook dilemma: Digital or print? Evidence from a selected US university](#)

[K Chavali](#), [RR Gundala](#) - TEM Journal, 2022 - ceeol.com

3. Sort by relevance:

- [Adoption of e-book readers among college students: A survey NM Foasberg](#) - Information technology and libraries, 2011 - ejournals.bc.edu

- [Higher education book publishing—from print to digital: a review of the literature RP Joseph](#) - Publishing Research Quarterly, 2015 - Springer

4. Include Patents:

- [A COMPARATIVE STUDY OF E-BOOKS AND PRINTED BOOKS ON ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE: PERCEPTION FROM THE UNIVERSITY STUDENTS](#)

N SAIJU, N TAMANG, P TAMANG, P BASTOLA... - INTERNATIONAL ..., 2025 - elibrary.r

CHAPTER 3: METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Method:

This study uses a **Mixed Method** Research approach, combining surveys for quantitative data (numbers) and open-ended questions for qualitative insights (opinions).

3.2 Tool Used:

1. **Questionnaire** – A structured set of questions prepared in Google Forms to collect both numerical data and opinions from students.
2. **Interview** – Online interview questions asked to students to gain deeper insights into their preferences.
3. **Software/Apps** – Tools like Google Forms for data collection and Excel for organizing and analyzing responses.

3.3 Sample Size:

The survey was completed by **44 college students**, who participated in the study.

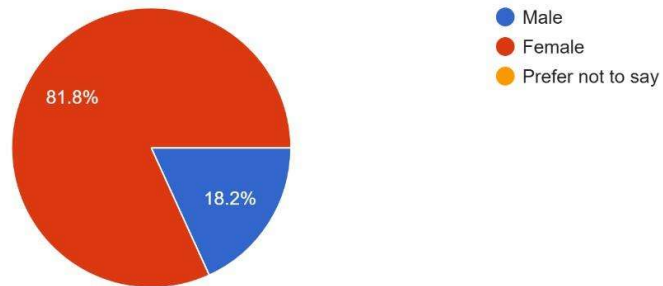
3.4 Sampling Method:

This study uses **Non-Probability** Sampling.

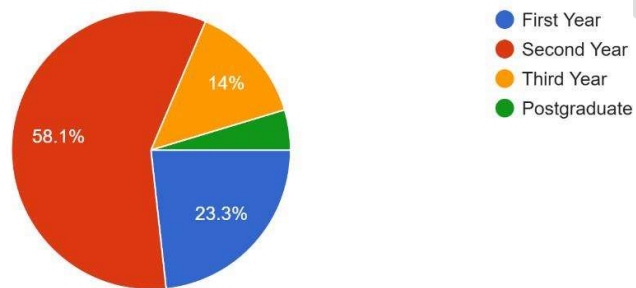
- a. **Convenience Sampling:** We selected participants who were easy to reach, such as friends and classmates.
- b. **Purposive Sampling:** We chose specific individuals who had knowledge about the topic.
- c. **Quota Sampling:** We selected participants from different groups based on certain characteristics.
- d. **Snowball Sampling:** We asked participants to share the survey with others to increase responses.

3.5 Data Analysis:

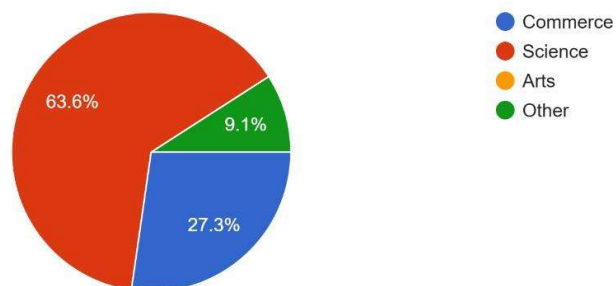
Gender
44 responses



Year of study
43 responses

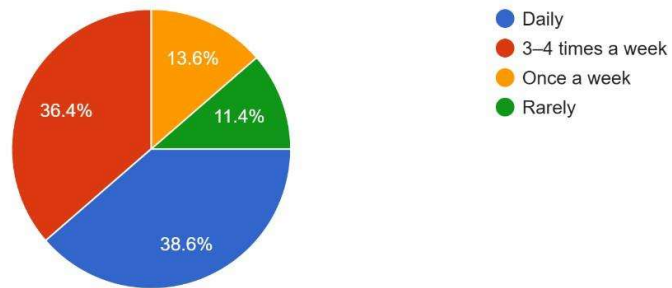


Field of Study
44 responses



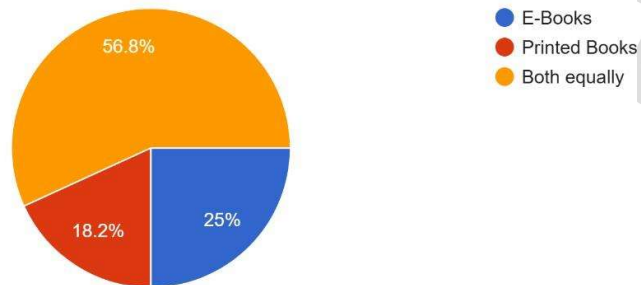
How often do you read books for academic purposes?

44 responses



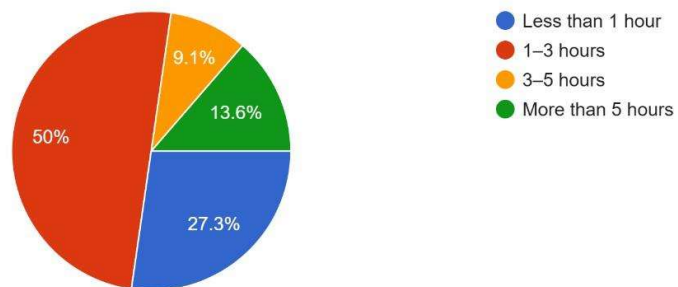
Which format do you prefer for academic reading?

44 responses



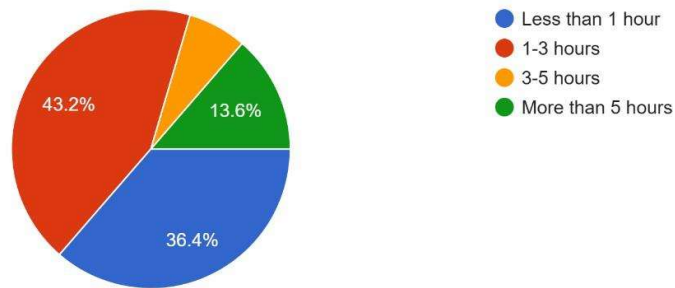
On average, how many hours per week do you spend reading e-books?

44 responses



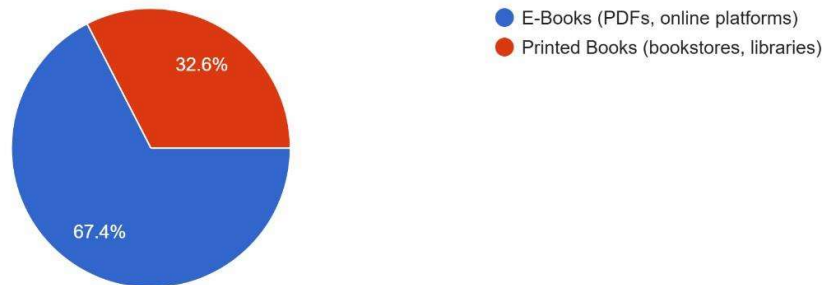
On average, how many hours per week do you spend reading printed books?

44 responses



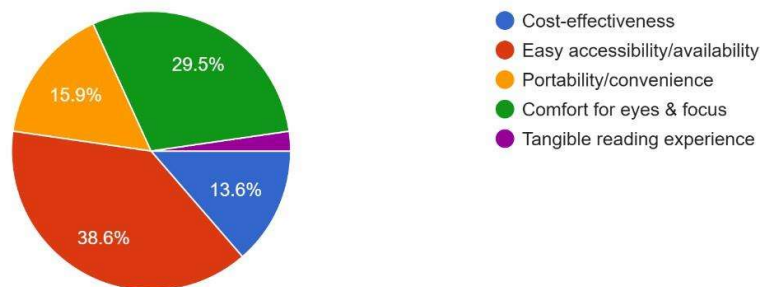
When buying or accessing books, what do you usually choose first?

43 responses



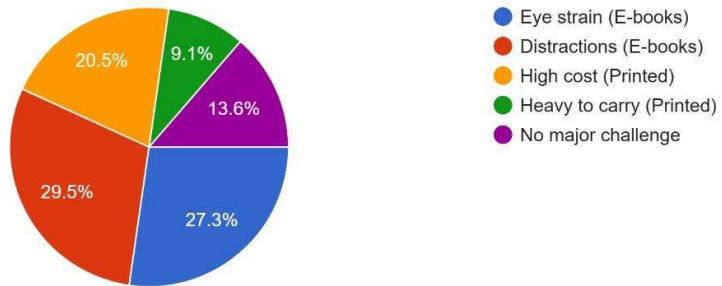
What is the main reason for your preference?

44 responses



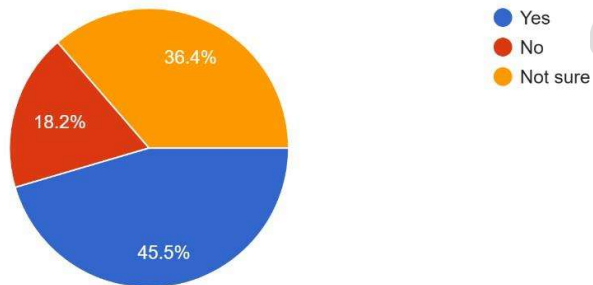
What is the biggest challenge you face with your less-preferred format?

44 responses



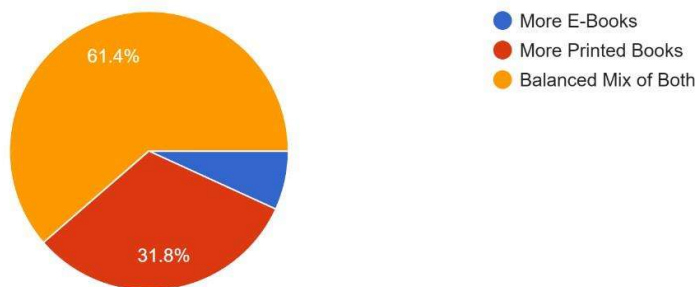
Do you think e-books will replace printed books in the future?

44 responses



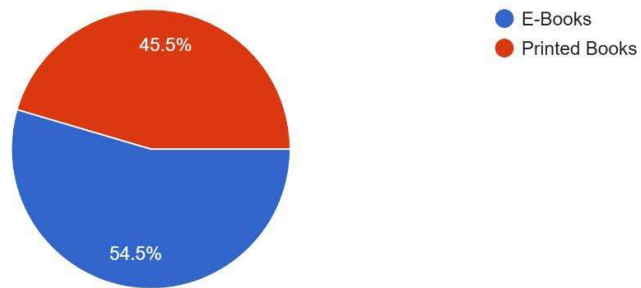
What should your college library focus on more?

44 responses



If you had to choose only one format for all your studies, which would you select?

44 responses



CHAPTER 4: FIELD WORK

DESCRIPTION, OBSERVATIONS, & ANALYSIS

4.1 Field Work Description:-

During my field project, I set out to explore college students' preferences between e-books and printed books. I started by designing a questionnaire in Google Forms and shared it with 44 students, collecting their responses online over several days. While waiting for responses, I observed students in the library and study areas to see how they engaged with different reading formats. After gathering all the data, I organized and analyzed it using Excel, uncovering interesting patterns about why students prefer one format over the other and the challenges they face. This hands-on experience gave me practical insights into both data collection and research analysis.

4.2 Observations:-

A survey on e-book vs. printed book preferences among college students typically reveals a strong leaning toward printed books, especially for in-depth academic reading, due to factors like better concentration, ease of note-taking, and reduced eye strain. However, e-books are often preferred for their convenience, portability, searchability, and lower cost, particularly for quick reference or when print options are unavailable. Students' choices often depend on the context—such as subject matter, purpose of reading, and availability of devices—with many adopting a hybrid approach. While digital literacy is growing, especially in younger generations, printed books continue to hold a significant edge in perceived effectiveness for learning.

4.3 Analysis:-

Students read books daily or 3–4 times a week, for academic purposes. Students use both e-books and printed books in a balanced way for academic reading. Students spend less than 1 hour to more than 3 hours on e-books weekly. Students spend from less than 1 hour to more than 3 hours on printed books weekly. Most of the students choose e-books when buying or accessing them. Ease of accessibility and availability, comfort for the eyes, and focus are the main factors influencing format preference. Challenges include eye strain and distractions for e-books and cost or heaviness for printed books. Many students think e-books will replace printed books in the future. Many students suggest a balanced mix of printed and e-books in the college library. If students had to choose only one format for all their studies, they preferred E- e-books.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.1 CONCLUSION:

The study shows that students read books daily or several times a week for academic purposes and use both e-books and printed books in a balanced manner. They spend anywhere from less than an hour to more than three hours weekly on both formats. When it comes to buying or accessing books, most students prefer e-books because of their accessibility, availability, comfort, and better focus. However, e-books also bring challenges such as eye strain and distractions, while printed books are often considered heavy and costly. Many students believe that e-books may replace printed books in the future, though they also recommend that college libraries maintain a balanced mix of both. Overall, the findings suggest that while students still value printed books, e-books are becoming the more preferred choice for academic study.

5.2 RECOMMENDATIONS:

The study recommends that colleges maintain a balance of both e-books and printed books in their libraries to suit different student needs. Since e-books are more accessible and cost-effective, their availability should be increased. However, printed books must also be kept for students who prefer traditional reading and better focus. To address issues like eye strain and distractions from e-books, students should be encouraged to follow healthy screen habits. Awareness programs about the benefits and limitations of both formats can also help students make better choices. Overall, a balanced mix of e-books and printed books will improve academic support and learning outcomes.

REFERENCES

For the Survey on E-Book vs. Printed Book Preference Among College Students, the references were taken from:

- **Chatgpt:-**<https://chatgpt.com/c/68c567ea-bc98-8329-ad93-6fab21c66cc7>
- **Perplexity:-** <https://www.perplexity.ai/>
- **Google Scholar:-** <https://scholar.google.com/>
- **GoogleForms:-** <https://forms.gle/7v9jaLUm5TmG73Xa7>
- **Microsoft Excel:-** <https://www.microsoft.com/excel>
- **Gemini:-** <https://gemini.google/>